

Battle Art Brief

What to draw for each NPC in a battle, and exactly when it shows up.

The short version

1. Draw each NPC at **192 × 192 pixels**: black pixel art on a **white background**, like the Therapist, Deborah and Samun files you sent.
2. Each NPC is a **checklist of poses**, with their own section. Work in waves: wave 1 puts them on screen, wave 2 makes the talk feel alive, wave 3 is their full range.
3. **Mouths are shut** in every pose except the talk loops. They only move while the NPC's quoted words are being said.
4. Send GIFs named `Profile_<Npc>_<State>.gif` (the exact names are on each NPC's page).

3 of 62 priority pieces are drawn across the four NPCs. The numbers in this brief come straight from the game's script: if a feeling never appears in an NPC's battle, you won't be asked to draw it.

HOW BIG IT REALLY IS



What you draw: 192 × 192 pixels (shown here at 1.5 in).



What the player sees: about 96 × 96 on a phone, with a thin border. Bold shapes read best. The mouth and eyes carry the feeling.

WHERE WE ARE

NPC	WAVE 1 ON SCREEN	WAVE 2 FEELS ALIVE	WAVE 3 FULL RANGE	TOTAL
Deborah Bible	2 / 2	0 / 8	0 / 8	2 / 18
Rwanda Crystals	0 / 2	0 / 8	0 / 6	0 / 16
Samun Bible	1 / 2	0 / 8	0 / 4	1 / 14
Rick Guns	0 / 2	0 / 8	0 / 4	0 / 14

Next: how a battle plays and the rules, then the whole checklist on one page, then one section per NPC with the exact file names, and last how to send the art.

A battle, beat by beat

A battle is a conversation. The NPC says something, you pick a feeling and answer, they react, then speak again. Their face changes with each step:

1 They are quiet

The resting face, held still. Nothing moves.

`idle`

2 They speak

The mouth loops while their *quoted* words type out, and closes the moment the quote ends.

`talk` or `talk_<feeling>`

3 Your turn

They wait for you, feeling what they feel: a short anticipation that plays once and holds its last frame.

`wait_<feeling>`

4 You answer

A moment before they speak again, they take your words: a one-time reaction, then back to rest.

`react_truth` `react_lie` `react_hit` `react_warm`

5 They close up (later)

When you miss what they were reaching for.

`react_cold`

6 The ending (later)

You stay in touch, or you are pushed away. During their story, five images are shown in silence.

`connect` `pushaway` `trauma_1...5`

RULES THAT MATTER

- **The mouth only moves in talk poses.** Idle, wait and react frames all have a shut mouth. Narration, stage directions and pauses never move it.
- **The talk loop starts on the idle picture.** Frame 0 of every talk loop is the idle face, so when they start speaking the mouth begins exactly where it was resting.
- **Every frame gets its full time.** 100 ms a frame by default (10 per second). If you export a GIF with your own frame delays, the game keeps them exactly.
- **Wait and react play once** and hold their last frame. A single still is fine for any of them; the game just holds it.
- **Anything not drawn yet falls back** to something that is: a missing feeling pose uses the plain talk or idle. So partial sets always work, and you can send in any order.
- **Living idle (optional).** The idle can be a short loop (a glance, a blink). It rests on frame 0 and plays now and then, so the screen stays calm. Samun's placeholder works this way.
- **Wearing a mask.** Some of Samun's and Rick's lines show a feeling on their face that isn't what they feel underneath. You draw the face they show.

THE EIGHT FEELINGS



The colors are the game's own feeling colors, for orientation only. The art stays black and white.

The whole checklist

PIECE	DEBORAH	RWANDA	SAMUN	RICK
idle	✓	○	✓	○
talk	✓	○	○	○
react_truth	○	○	○	○
react_lie	○	○	○	○
react_hit	○	○	○	○
react_warm	○	○	○	○
 Happy talk + wait	○ 1	SKIP	○ 6	SKIP
 Trust talk + wait	SKIP	SKIP	SKIP	SKIP
 Fear talk + wait	○ 2	○ 4	○ 1	○ 2
 Surprise talk + wait	SKIP	○ 2	SKIP	SKIP
 Sadness talk + wait	○ 3	SKIP	○ 2	SKIP
 Disgust talk + wait	○ 1	○ 1	SKIP	○ 1
 Anger talk + wait	○ 1	○ 1	○ 1	○ 7
 Anxiety talk + wait	○ 2	○ 2	SKIP	○ 1
react_cold later	LATER	LATER	LATER	LATER
connect later	LATER	LATER	LATER	LATER
pushaway later	LATER	LATER	LATER	LATER
trauma_1...5 later	LATER	LATER	LATER	LATER

✓ drawn · ○ to draw (the small number is how many battle beats use that feeling) · ½ one of the two · skip: never shown, don't draw
 · later: not in the game yet.

Deborah

Faith. Loyalty. Buried doubt.

2 of 18 pieces drawn



still

idle (in the game now)



frame 0

talk loop (in the game now)



frame 1



frame 2



frame 0



frame 1

extras received, not a state yet

WHAT TO DRAW, IN ORDER

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
WAVE 1: GET THEM ON SCREEN				
1	Profile_Deborah_Idle.gif	The resting face. Mouth shut , eyes open, held still. Can be a short loop (a glance, a blink) if the mouth stays shut in every frame.	1, or a short loop	✓ in
1	Profile_Deborah_Talk.gif	Mouth moving, only while their quoted words are being typed . Loops. Frame 0 must be the idle picture, so the mouth starts shut.	3, looping	✓ in
WAVE 2: MAKE THE CONVERSATION FEEL ALIVE				
2	Profile_Deborah_React_Truth.gif	A true answer lands. Plays once, just before they speak. Mouth shut.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Deborah_React_Lie.gif	A comforting lie lands. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Deborah_React_Hit.gif	A big swing : your words hit hard. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Deborah_React_Warm.gif	They turn toward you (you answered what they were reaching for).	3 to 4, once	to draw
☒ Sadness in 3 of their 10 beats. Like: "God took my boy when He needed him. I just have to trust that."				
2	Profile_Deborah_Talk_Sadness.gif	Speaking in Sadness . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
2	Profile_Deborah_Wait_Sadness.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Sadness . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
☒ Fear in 2 of their 10 beats. Like: "The church sent someone? After all this time?"				
2	Profile_Deborah_Talk_Fear.gif	Speaking in Fear . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
2	Profile_Deborah_Wait_Fear.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Fear . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
WAVE 3: THEIR FULL RANGE				
 Anxiety	in 2 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"You don't know what it's like to lose a child."</i>			
3	Profile_Deborah_Talk_Anxiety.gif	Speaking in Anxiety . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Deborah_Wait_Anxiety.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Anxiety . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
 Happy	in 1 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"I knew you'd understand. Most people don't want to hear it."</i>			
3	Profile_Deborah_Talk_Happy.gif	Speaking in Happy . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Deborah_Wait_Happy.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Happy . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
 Disgust	in 1 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"Everyone who knew him is either gone or pretending they weren't there."</i>			
3	Profile_Deborah_Talk_Disgust.gif	Speaking in Disgust . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Deborah_Wait_Disgust.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Disgust . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
 Anger	in 1 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"You heard. Everybody heard. Go on — say the part where it was God's will."</i>			
3	Profile_Deborah_Talk_Anger.gif	Speaking in Anger . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Deborah_Wait_Anger.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Anger . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw

LATER: NOT IN THE GAME YET

Don't start these first. We hook them up as the art arrives.

Profile_Deborah_React_Cold.gif	They close up (you missed what they were reaching for). 3 to 4 frames, once.
Profile_Deborah_Connect.gif	The stay-in-touch moment. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Deborah_Pushaway.gif	You are pushed away at the end. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Deborah_Trauma_1.gif to _5.gif	Five images, one per beat of their story, shown in silence. Proposed size 240 × 240 (tell us if you would rather match 192).

SKIP: DEBORAH NEVER SHOWS THESE

No battle beat uses them, so no talk or wait pieces are needed.

 **Trust**  **Surprise**

Rwanda

Feeling everything. Processing nothing.

0 of 16 pieces drawn



WHAT TO DRAW, IN ORDER

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
WAVE 1: GET THEM ON SCREEN				
1	Profile_Rwanda_Idle.gif	The resting face. Mouth shut , eyes open, held still. Can be a short loop (a glance, a blink) if the mouth stays shut in every frame.	1, or a short loop	to draw
1	Profile_Rwanda_Talk.gif	Mouth moving, only while their quoted words are being typed . Loops. Frame 0 must be the idle picture, so the mouth starts shut.	3, looping	to draw
WAVE 2: MAKE THE CONVERSATION FEEL ALIVE				
2	Profile_Rwanda_React_Truth.gif	A true answer lands. Plays once, just before they speak. Mouth shut.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Rwanda_React_Lie.gif	A comforting lie lands. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Rwanda_React_Hit.gif	A big swing : your words hit hard. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Rwanda_React_Warm.gif	They turn toward you (you answered what they were reaching for).	3 to 4, once	to draw
Fear in 4 of their 10 beats. Like: "You see it too, right. Whatever's out there tonight."				
2	Profile_Rwanda_Talk_Fear.gif	Speaking in Fear . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
2	Profile_Rwanda_Wait_Fear.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Fear . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
Surprise in 2 of their 10 beats. Like: "You actually mean that? Most people just want me to perform."				
2	Profile_Rwanda_Talk_Surprise.gif	Speaking in Surprise . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
2	Profile_Rwanda_Wait_Surprise.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Surprise . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
WAVE 3: THEIR FULL RANGE				
Anxiety in 2 of their 10 beats. Like: "You want to know the actual tiring part? It's not them. It's flinching before they even say anything."				
3	Profile_Rwanda_Talk_Anxiety.gif	Speaking in Anxiety . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
3	Profile_Rwanda_Wait_Anxiety.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Anxiety . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
Disgust in 1 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"Right. Sure. I'm doing fine."</i>				
3	Profile_Rwanda_Talk_Disgust.gif	Speaking in Disgust . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Rwanda_Wait_Disgust.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Disgust . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
Anger in 1 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"Why do I gotta sand myself down just to be digestible?"</i>				
3	Profile_Rwanda_Talk_Anger.gif	Speaking in Anger . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Rwanda_Wait_Anger.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Anger . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw

LATER: NOT IN THE GAME YET

Don't start these first. We hook them up as the art arrives.

Profile_Rwanda_React_Cold.gif	They close up (you missed what they were reaching for). 3 to 4 frames, once.
Profile_Rwanda_Connect.gif	The stay-in-touch moment. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Rwanda_Pushaway.gif	You are pushed away at the end. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Rwanda_Trauma_1.gif to _5.gif	Five images, one per beat of their story, shown in silence. Proposed size 240 × 240 (tell us if you would rather match 192).

SKIP: RWANDA NEVER SHOWS THESE

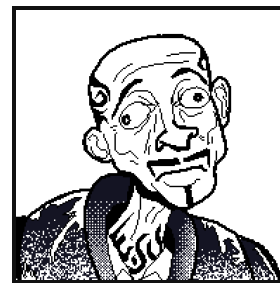
No battle beat uses them, so no talk or wait pieces are needed.

Happy
Trust
Sadness

Samun

Faith. Loyalty. Buried doubt.

1 of 14 pieces drawn



idle (in the game now)

WHAT TO DRAW, IN ORDER

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
WAVE 1: GET THEM ON SCREEN				
1	Profile_Samun_Idle.gif	The resting face. Mouth shut , eyes open, held still. Can be a short loop (a glance, a blink) if the mouth stays shut in every frame.	1, or a short loop	✓ in
1	Profile_Samun_Talk.gif	Mouth moving, only while their quoted words are being typed . Loops. Frame 0 must be the idle picture, so the mouth starts shut.	3, looping	to draw
WAVE 2: MAKE THE CONVERSATION FEEL ALIVE				
2	Profile_Samun_React_Truth.gif	A true answer lands. Plays once, just before they speak. Mouth shut.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Samun_React_Lie.gif	A comforting lie lands. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Samun_React_Hit.gif	A big swing : your words hit hard. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Samun_React_Warm.gif	They turn toward you (you answered what they were reaching for).	3 to 4, once	to draw
Happy in 6 of their 10 beats. Like: "Man, everyone's hooked on something. Mine's just more honest." A mask: the face wears Happy over Fear, Disgust.				
2	Profile_Samun_Talk_Happy.gif	Speaking in Happy . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
2	Profile_Samun_Wait_Happy.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Happy . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
Sadness in 2 of their 10 beats. Like: "Tried quitting once. Four days. Everybody around me got worse, not me."				
2	Profile_Samun_Talk_Sadness.gif	Speaking in Sadness . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
2	Profile_Samun_Wait_Sadness.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Sadness . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
WAVE 3: THEIR FULL RANGE				
Fear in 1 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"Ask it, then. Everybody who comes in here asks it eventually."</i>				
3	Profile_Samun_Talk_Fear.gif	Speaking in Fear . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Samun_Wait_Fear.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Fear . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
Anger in 1 of their 10 beats. Like: <i>"Easy for you to say. You're not the one hurting."</i> A mask: the face wears Anger over Sadness.				
3	Profile_Samun_Talk_Anger.gif	Speaking in Anger . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Samun_Wait_Anger.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Anger . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw

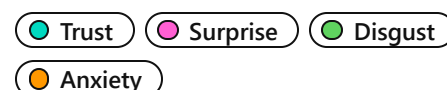
LATER: NOT IN THE GAME YET

Don't start these first. We hook them up as the art arrives.

Profile_Samun_React_Cold.gif	They close up (you missed what they were reaching for). 3 to 4 frames, once.
Profile_Samun_Connect.gif	The stay-in-touch moment. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Samun_Pushaway.gif	You are pushed away at the end. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Samun_Trauma_1.gif to _5.gif	Five images, one per beat of their story, shown in silence. Proposed size 240 × 240 (tell us if you would rather match 192).

SKIP: SAMUN NEVER SHOWS THESE

No battle beat uses them, so no talk or wait pieces are needed.



Rick

Confrontation. Force. No flinching.

0 of 14 pieces drawn



WHAT TO DRAW, IN ORDER

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
WAVE 1: GET THEM ON SCREEN				
1	Profile_Rick_Idle.gif	The resting face. Mouth shut , eyes open, held still. Can be a short loop (a glance, a blink) if the mouth stays shut in every frame.	1, or a short loop	to draw
1	Profile_Rick_Talk.gif	Mouth moving, only while their quoted words are being typed . Loops. Frame 0 must be the idle picture, so the mouth starts shut.	3, looping	to draw
WAVE 2: MAKE THE CONVERSATION FEEL ALIVE				
2	Profile_Rick_React_Truth.gif	A true answer lands. Plays once, just before they speak. Mouth shut.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Rick_React_Lie.gif	A comforting lie lands. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Rick_React_Hit.gif	A big swing : your words hit hard. Plays once, just before they speak.	3 to 4, once	to draw
2	Profile_Rick_React_Warm.gif	They turn toward you (you answered what they were reaching for).	3 to 4, once	to draw
Anger in 7 of their 11 beats. Like: "Guy looked at me wrong outside. Now he's got a busted jaw and I got my patch back. That's just how it works out here." A mask: the face wears Anger over Fear, Disgust.				
2	Profile_Rick_Talk_Anger.gif	Speaking in Anger . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
2	Profile_Rick_Wait_Anger.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Anger . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
Fear in 2 of their 11 beats. Like: "You know why I got the patch tattooed instead of just wearing it? Can't take off skin."				
2	Profile_Rick_Talk_Fear.gif	Speaking in Fear . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
2	Profile_Rick_Wait_Fear.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Fear . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
WAVE 3: THEIR FULL RANGE				
Disgust in 1 of their 11 beats. Like: "Word gets around. I know what you are."				
3	Profile_Rick_Talk_Disgust.gif	Speaking in Disgust . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw

WAVE	FILE NAME	WHAT IT IS	FRAMES	STATUS
3	Profile_Rick_Wait_Disgust.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Disgust . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw
 Anxiety in 1 of their 11 beats. Like: <i>"You buying because you want something, or because I scare you?"</i>				
3	Profile_Rick_Talk_Anxiety.gif	Speaking in Anxiety . Frame 0 is the idle picture.	3, looping	to draw
3	Profile_Rick_Wait_Anxiety.gif	Waiting on you, feeling Anxiety . Plays once, holds the last frame. Mouth shut.	1 to 4, once	to draw

LATER: NOT IN THE GAME YET

Don't start these first. We hook them up as the art arrives.

Profile_Rick_React_Cold.gif	They close up (you missed what they were reaching for). 3 to 4 frames, once.
Profile_Rick_Connect.gif	The stay-in-touch moment. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Rick_Pushaway.gif	You are pushed away at the end. One picture, or a short once-through.
Profile_Rick_Trauma_1.gif to _5.gif	Five images, one per beat of their story, shown in silence. Proposed size 240 × 240 (tell us if you would rather match 192).

SKIP: RICK NEVER SHOWS THESE

No battle beat uses them, so no talk or wait pieces are needed.



Sending the art

Format	GIF. One frame is a still, several frames are an animation. 192 × 192 pixels (a whole multiple like 1920 × 1920 is also fine if you draw big; we check it shrinks cleanly).
Look	Black pixel art on white, no antialiasing, no glow or blur. (The existing files also use one near-black ink for dithering, which is fine.)
Names	<code>Profile_<Npc>_<State>.gif</code> with the NPC and state capitalised: <code>Profile_Deborah_Talk.gif</code> , <code>Profile_Samun_Wait_Anger.gif</code> , <code>Profile_Rick_React_Hit.gif</code> . The exact names for every piece are on the NPC pages.
Timing	100 ms a frame unless you choose otherwise. Loops for talk, one-shots for wait and react: the game decides, you just draw the frames in order.
Where	The shared Drive: <code>Chapter 1 / NPCs / <Npc></code> . Drop new files in the NPC's folder (make it if it is not there yet); the same name again means "replace".
Odd names	Don't worry about them. If a file is named differently (like <code>Profile_Deborah01.gif</code>), we map it by hand. Just tell us what it is.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR YOU

- Trauma / confession images: **240 × 240** (proposed, shown bigger) or match the 192 faces?
- The placeholder pieces we have (Samun's glance loop, Deborah's squint and open-mouth faces): is any of them meant for a specific moment? For example, Deborah's open mouth could be the gasp when a hit lands.

This brief is generated from the game (`npm run battle-art`), so it updates when the script or the art changes. Questions? Ask whoever sent you this brief.